

Year-End Performance Review 2026

Harsha | Senior Software Engineer | Vstar (EDR) / ICMP Document Ingestion

1. Success & Achievements

Cisive Egress: Full Ownership

I owned the Cisive integration end to end: requirements, egress requests, approvals, implementation, and production rollout. Moving from NDM file drops to direct Cisive API calls removed our dependency on file landing paths and reduced manual intervention.

- **Built for scale:** Our integration sends parallel requests at **more than 1,000 calls per minute**. The current limit is on Cisive's side: they throttle us with HTTP 429 (Too Many Requests).
- **Resilient by design:** I implemented retry handling for throttled calls, so every document is still retrieved reliably with no data loss.
- Our side is ready for higher volumes now. When Cisive raises their capacity, throughput scales without any changes from us.

Apigee Hybrid Migration (from Legacy RISE)

I led the migration of our internal APIs from legacy RISE to Apigee Hybrid. I coordinated the requests and approvals across teams and completed the cutover with no disruption to downstream consumers.

Unstructured Data Implementation

I delivered the unstructured data solution on a tight timeline. I chose a standalone-job design so it could ship quickly without risk to the existing 40+ production jobs.

FADV Processing Performance: ~67% Improvement

I raised FADV ingestion throughput from **600 to 1,000 ingestions per hour**, cutting backlog processing time and SLA pressure.

ICMP Bulk Ingestion: BA Self-Service UI

I built a high-performance bulk ingestion capability that **inserts 2 million records in under 6 seconds**. BAs configure column mappings and ingest records themselves through the UI, without any engineering involvement.

- **Before:** every new Excel layout (new columns or a new column order) needed a **5-point development story plus a 3-point execution story** with the platform support team.
- **After:** BAs handle it themselves. That recurring effort is gone, business turnaround is faster, and engineering capacity has gone back to roadmap work.

Workflow Screens: Self-Service Validation, Correction, and Bulk Export

- **Self-service validation:** Users can upload their file and see every validation result before ingestion.
- **In-place correction:** If records fail validation, users fix them directly on the screen and re-ingest, without raising a request to engineering.
- **Automatic status flow:** Corrected records move automatically into the workflow screen with the right status, giving users full visibility end to end.
- **Bulk export:** Users can extract large result sets directly instead of raising manual data requests.

.NET 10 Migration and AutoMapper Removal

I migrated applications to .NET 10 and removed AutoMapper across the solution. Where mappings were too complex to convert automatically, I replaced them with explicit, testable mapping logic. This kept the stack supported and removed a third-party dependency.

Security and Vulnerability Remediation

- I resolved a large set of vulnerability findings, including DOM-based XSS issues flagged by Checkmarx across jQuery/MVC screens.
- I wrote custom sanitization utilities within tight constraints: no third-party libraries and no server-side changes.

Technical Direction for the Team

- I produced the first architecture review of the legacy Vstar platform and a phased modernization roadmap, presented to architects and engineers.
- I designed the monthly release-branch strategy and briefed developers and leads on it, which improved release traceability.

HRIT Hackathon: 2nd Runner-Up

I wrote **99% of the Python backend APIs** and **100% of the Angular UI** (Angular Material) for our HR onboarding app.

2. What Went Well / What Stands Out

- **Measurable business impact:** 2M records ingested in under 6 seconds, a ~67% FADV throughput gain, and a recurring 8-point effort per layout change eliminated.
- **Self-service by design:** BAs and users now validate, correct, and ingest data themselves, reducing support requests and turnaround time.
- **Ownership of cross-team work:** The Cisive egress and the Apigee migration both required coordination with approvers, platform teams, and external vendors, and I drove them to completion.
- **Balancing delivery and platform health:** I shipped features while also reducing technical debt and risk through .NET 10, AutoMapper removal, and security fixes.
- **Shaping direction:** My architecture review and branching strategy are influencing how the team builds and releases, beyond my own deliverables.

3. Strengths & Observed Behaviours

- **Ownership and accountability:** I take initiatives from idea to production, including approvals, coordination, and support.
- **Technical leadership:** I make sound design decisions sized to the system's real scale, and I explain the trade-offs to stakeholders.
- **Business-focused thinking:** I look for solutions that remove recurring effort and dependency, not just the immediate request.
- **Influence without authority:** I drive adoption of new practices, such as release branching and architecture standards, through clear communication and documentation.
- **Hands-on depth:** I deliver across .NET, Python, and Angular, so I can unblock others and review work credibly.

- **Quality and risk mindset:** I build within controls, fix security issues properly, and protect production stability.

4. Areas of Focus (Next Year: Growing into the Lead Role)

Leadership

- **Lead through others:** I will move from building most deliverables myself to planning, delegating, and reviewing, so the team's output scales.
- **Mentoring:** I will develop junior and mid-level engineers through design walkthroughs, code reviews, and pairing.
- **Stakeholder management:** I will own technical communication with BAs, product, and partner teams for the Vstar roadmap.
- **Visibility:** I will present outcomes and architecture decisions to leadership and wider forums.

Technical Roadmap

- Drive the phased modernization of Vstar (EDR) into independently deployable services, starting with the background job hosts.
- Lead the .NET MVC → Angular migration and set up reusable UI patterns for the team.
- Complete the Kendo UI replacement to remove the licensing dependency.
- Raise test coverage on new and refactored code (target 90%) and enforce it in CI.
- Extend the BA self-service model to other repetitive change requests.
- Apply AI/RAG to practical problems in background-check document processing.

5. Risk Overlay

- **Security:** I remediated Checkmarx findings within required timelines without introducing unapproved libraries.
- **Third-party and technology controls:** I followed approval processes. Where a library wasn't authorized, I built an in-house alternative instead of working around the control. Removing AutoMapper and Kendo also reduces licensing and supply-chain risk.
- **Egress and integration governance:** I took all Cive egress through formal approval. The Apigee migration brought our APIs under the governed enterprise gateway.
- **Sensitive data:** Vstar handles employee background-check documents containing PII. I followed data-handling standards: no document persistence in the pass-through layer, no secrets in code, and controlled storage.
- **Controls in self-service:** The bulk ingestion UI and workflow screens include validation and controlled execution, which reduces manual Excel errors and ad-hoc production changes by engineers.
- **Change management:** All releases and migrations followed change management processes. The release-branch strategy improves traceability of what is deployed.
- **Risk culture:** I raise risks and blockers early. I completed all mandatory risk and compliance training on time, and had no audit findings or policy breaches attributed to my work.

6. Overall Summary

This year I delivered measurable impact while increasingly operating at a lead level. I took full ownership of the Cive egress integration, building it to handle more than 1,000 requests per minute with resilient retry handling, and led the migration from RISE to Apigee Hybrid. I also delivered the

unstructured data solution on a tight timeline and improved FADV processing from 600 to 1,000 ingestions per hour.

My most impactful work was the ICMP bulk ingestion UI, which inserts 2 million records in under 6 seconds. BAs can now configure and ingest data themselves, which eliminated an 8-point engineering and support effort for every layout change. On the workflow screens, users now validate, correct, and re-ingest their own data, with records flowing automatically into the right status. Alongside feature delivery, I reduced risk and technical debt through the .NET 10 migration, AutoMapper removal, bulk export, and security remediation. I also placed 2nd runner-up in the HRIT Hackathon, building nearly all of the APIs and the full UI.

Beyond my own deliverables, I set technical direction for the team through the Vstar architecture roadmap and the release-branch strategy. Next year I want to step fully into the Lead role: driving the Vstar modernization and Angular migration, mentoring engineers, delegating effectively, and owning stakeholder communication, so the team and the platform scale together.